

Exploring Dataset Discovery Experiences

You are invited to take part in a study conducted by researchers from <redacted institution>. The purpose of the study is to gain insights into how you discover and choose datasets for your data-driven tasks and to understand the information that aids you in the data discovery process. (Please note that for the purpose of this study, we are focusing solely on **tabular data**, rather than image or text data.)

Informed Consent

Description: We are researchers at the <redacted institution> studying the role that visualization can play in supporting data valuation judgments. Our study procedure involves surveying participants about their data discovery process, which entails asking participants questions about their past experiences about seeking and assessing the value of new datasets for various tasks. We are seeking individuals who work with data on a regular basis. We asked interested individuals email us with a brief description of their experiences working with data and visualization to determine their eligibility. Our questions may touch on participants' personal work experiences, but they have the flexibility to choose which specific experiences to report. Participation is completely voluntary, and participants may withdraw from the study at any time. Participating should take about 20 minutes.

Incentives: Participants who complete the survey will be enter a lottery with 10% chance of winning a \$100 gift card as compensation for their time.

Risks and Benefits: Your participation in this study does not involve any risk to you beyond that of everyday life. Taking part in this research may not benefit you personally, but we may learn new things that could help others. In particular, we hope to learn how visualization may support users assess the value of data when seeking new datasets.

Confidentiality: Your participation in this study is completely confidential. We will not reveal your identity or the fact of your participation to anyone outside the study team. Identifiable data will never be shared outside the research team. De-identified information from this study may be used for future research studies or shared with other researchers for future research without your additional informed consent. If you decide to withdraw from this study, any data already collected will be destroyed.

Surveys will be conducted through Google Forms, and email addresses will be collected solely for communication purposes and to ensure each participant contributes only once. The study team may transcribe or directly quote your responses, along with input from other anonymous participants, in a published report.

Contacts & Questions:

If you have questions or concerns about the study, you can contact the researchers at <redacted contact information>. If you have any questions about your rights as a participant in

this research, feel you have been harmed, or wish to discuss other study-related concerns with someone who is not part of the research team, you can contact the <redacted contact information>.

Consent:

Participation is voluntary. Refusal to participate or withdrawing from the research will involve no penalty or loss of benefits to which you might otherwise be entitled.

By pressing the “next” button below, you confirm that you have read the consent form, are at least 18 years old, and agree to participate in the research. Please print or save a copy of this page for your records.

1. What role do you work in that requires access to data sources, and for what purposes do you typically use data? (If you have a long work history working with data, please describe your most recent role where you spent a substantial amount of time)

Long Answer Text

2. How long have you been working with data?

Short Answer Text

3. What industry do you work in?

Short Answer Text

4. How often do you use visualizations in your work?

Mark only one oval.

Never

Rarely

Every few months

Monthly

Weekly

Multiple times per week

Positive Experience

1. Could you describe a specific instance where you successfully found one or more new dataset(s) that contributed to a data-driven task? What were you trying to achieve by searching for a new dataset? If you had any particular criteria for success, what were they? Please give as much detail as possible since the following questions will ask you to elaborate on this particular scenario.

Long Answer Text

2. In this particular scenario, from where did you obtain the new dataset(s)?

Short Answer Text

3. How did you assess the potential value of the dataset(s), considering whether it's worthwhile to download (or pay for if relevant) and work with?

Long Answer Text

4. What information assisted you in making this assessment? (select all that apply)

Source reputation

User reviews

Metadata

Data collection conditions

Prevalence of missing data

Ability to access full datasets

Sample data

Visualizations

Other:

The following questions (5-8) ask you to consider the usefulness of the “provided information,” referring to the pieces of information you indicated in response to question 4 that you used to assess the potential value of this dataset.

5. Do you believe the provided information was sufficient to assess whether the data can fulfill your intended purpose?

Yes

No

Not Sure

6. Do you believe the provided information was sufficient to gauge whether the data is of usable quality?

Yes

No

Not Sure

7. If you needed to pay to access the dataset(s), do you believe the provided information was sufficient for you to decide whether to pay to access this data?

Long Answer Text

8. In what ways is the provided information adequate or inadequate for assessing each of the following. (If you choose "not sure" above, please also specify the reasons for your uncertainty.):

(a) whether a dataset can fulfill your intended purpose

Long Answer Text

(b) if data is of sufficient quality

Long Answer Text

(c) if data is worth paying some price to access?

Long Answer Text

Negative Experience

1. Could you describe a specific instance where you were unsuccessful in the sense that the datasets you found could not contribute to a data-driven task? What were you trying to achieve by searching for a new dataset? What were the challenges that led to this outcome? Please give as much detail as possible since the following questions will ask you to elaborate on this particular scenario.

Long Answer Text

2. In this particular scenario, from where did you obtain the new dataset(s)?

Short Answer Text

3. How did you assess the potential value of the dataset(s), considering whether it's worthwhile to download (or pay for if relevant) and work with?

Long Answer Text

4. What information assisted you in making this assessment? (select all that apply)

Source reputation

User reviews

Metadata

Data collection conditions

Prevalence of missing data

Ability to access full datasets

Sample data

Visualizations

Other:

The following questions (5-8) ask you to consider the usefulness of the “provided information,” referring to the pieces of information you indicated in response to question 4 that you used to assess the potential value of this dataset.

5. Do you believe the provided information was sufficient to assess whether the data can fulfill your intended purpose?

Yes

No

Not Sure

6. Do you believe the provided information was sufficient to gauge whether the data is of usable quality?

Yes

No

Not Sure

7. If you needed to pay to access the dataset(s), do you believe the provided information was sufficient for you to decide whether to pay to access this data?

Long Answer Text

8. In what ways is the provided information adequate or inadequate for assessing each of the following. (If you choose "not sure" above, please also specify the reasons for your uncertainty.):

(a) whether a dataset can fulfill your intended purpose

Long Answer Text

(b) if data is of sufficient quality

Long Answer Text

(c) if data is worth paying some price to access?

Long Answer Text

9. What additional information would enhance your ability to assess the potential value of the dataset(s) effectively? Additionally, if you found anything about this survey confusing, please use this space to let us know.

Long Answer Text